

the sender and recipient are able to communicate with each other irrespective of location or communication device. For example, a voice call to a person's desk phone can be re-routed to his cell phone or email as a voice mail attachment.

8.3.27 VAR

Value Added Reseller. A VAR is an essential component in the sales and support of software. VARs are trained by the software and hardware companies to provide different levels of support to the end customer. Typically, VARs create their own, special packages on top of the main offering which acts as incentive to the prospective buyer. For example a VAR of ERP software may decide to provide a bundled offer to its customers which includes both the hardware and the software.

8.3.28 Virtualisation

The process of creating a virtual version of something such as an operating system, a server, storage devices, or network resources. Operating system virtualisation enables the user to use a software to run multiple operating systems on the same computer hardware. Some virtualisation software also allows you the capability of dynamically adding more hardware to increase the power and range of the virtualised software. There are three main areas of virtualisation that are increasingly becoming popular. One is network virtualisation, where the combined bandwidth of the network is split into several channels independent from each other and which can be assigned to a particular server or device in real time. By using virtualisation, users need not be concerned with the underlying complexity of the actual physical network. The second is to consolidate storage from multiple network storage devices into a single virtualised storage device that is managed from a single place. As far as the end-user is concerned, he will be dealing only with a hard disk, and will have no idea whether the drive is virtualised or not. The third is in server virtualisation, where a user may have full access to a range of operating system services in a virtualised environment.